had ruled all of India. So though Pakistan's new National Assembly should have been convened in Dhaka that March, Bhutto wouldn't allow a wavering Yahya to do it, offering instead to fly east himself to cut a deal with Mujib.

In some respects, Bhutto and Mujib, both born to relish political power, were alike: passionate orators, charismatic leaders, inspiring millions to cheer for them and, if need be, to die for them. Bhutto was much richer, however, having inherited vast feudal estates in Sind, whereas Mujib had earned his first rupees in Calcutta selling insurance. Bhutto's hero was Napoleon, whose sword hung facing the gold-topped Louis XIV desk in his Karachi library. Mujib, however, looked no further for his role model than to Bengal's one and only prime minister of Pakistan, H. S. Suhrawardy. It was intolerable for Bhutto to allow such a lowborn person to became Pakistan's premier, especially now that he himself was ready to take on that job.

He first persuaded Yahya to put off convening a new National Assembly, though popular and international pressure was building daily, Delhi and Washington wondering why Yahya hadn't done so immediately. But Yahya did whatever Bhutto told him, since Zulfi was, after all, so much more sophisticated, a graduate of several colleges in California, a student of Christ Church, Oxford, a Lincoln's Inn barrister, and a wealthy Sindhi landlord. Moreover, Bhutto had a brilliant idea of how best to resolve this problem.

He flew to Dhaka in late March and offered Mujib what he considered a very generous deal: "You will be prime minister here, and I will be prime minister there!" *Two Pakistans!* Not for nothing had Bhutto mastered the works of Machiavelli at Berkeley. Only Mujib wasn't buying it. He had won the whole loaf in a free and fair election, after all; why now take only half? To every reporter in Dhaka he protested: "First they want credit for holding free elections, but now that they've lost, they want to change the rules, so they fly this Sindhi here to beg me to play their dirty game!" Bhutto was not amused. Nor was Yahya, who had flown out himself in the last week of March to close the deal, believing that the clever, suave Bhutto would surely sway this Bengali rustic to accept his offer.

On 25 March 1971, however, Yahya Khan flew home in frustration, even as the sun started to set over Bangladesh. The next morning, Bhutto followed him. Pakistan's toughest general, Tikka Khan, ordered his West Pakistani troops to open fire that night, pointing the long guns of their